



The Bach Flower Remedies

ILLUSTRATIONS AND
PREPARATIONS



NORA WEEKS
and
VICTOR BULLEN
Friends and
colleagues of
Edward Bach





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Nora Weeks and Victor Bullen

The illustrations in the original book
were reproductions of water colours by
Marjorie Pemberton Piggott.

As these now illustrate *The Handbook of the Bach Flower Remedies*
rather than repeat them, we have chosen to include
photographs of the flowers taken by Judy Howard
of the Dr Edward Bach Centre.



SAFFRON WALDEN
THE C.W. DANIEL COMPANY LIMITED

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About the Book

Flower healing is the simple and natural method of healing through personality by means of wild flowers, discovered by the late Dr Edward Bach, MB, BS, MRCS, LRCP, DPH. He was a great physician who combined compassion for all who suffer, with a deep love for Nature, her trees and plants.

Dr Bach practised for many years as a Harley Street consultant and bacteriologist but gave up his lucrative practice in 1930 to devote his full time to perfecting this system of healing described in full in his booklet *The Twelve Healers and Other Remedies*.

Nora Weeks and Victor Bullen worked with Dr Bach and it was to them that the responsibility of his work was bequeathed. In 1964, as a tribute to the doctor's work they published this book to share with others the essence of Nature within the Bach Flower Remedies.

This new edition, with coloured photographs, was published in 1990 and then revised and reprinted in 1998.

Dedication

This book is dedicated to Edward Bach, physician, with the love and gratitude of those who knew and worked with him for many years, and in compliance with his wish that every detail of the knowledge he had gained for the alleviation of suffering and unhappiness should be freely available for everyone.

Edward Bach, born in Moseley, Warwickshire in 1886, trained and qualified at University College Hospital, London, gaining the Diploma of Public Health at Cambridge in 1914. He then practised as consultant, bacteriologist and homoeopath for over sixteen years in London.

It was during his medical training that he first came to the conclusion that sickness and disease were not primarily due to physical causes, but to some deeper disharmony within the sufferer himself. That distress of mind, such as fear, worry, over-anxiety, impatience, so depletes the vitality of the individual that the body loses its natural resistance to disease and is then an easy prey to any infection, any form of illness.

These conclusions were strengthened and confirmed by Dr. Bach's observations during his sixteen years of medical practice, and in 1930 he determined to devote his whole time to the search for a simple method of treatment and harmless Remedies amongst the wild flowers of the countryside.

He gave up his big London practice and during the next seven years until his death in 1936, he perfected this system of healing and found thirty-eight Remedies, all, with one exception, the flowers of plants, trees and bushes.

With the help of the healing properties of these flowers, the sufferer can gain strength to overcome his anxieties, his fears and depressions, and so assist in his own healing, and can take the flower Remedies, if he wishes, at the same time as any other medicine or treatment.

Introduction

The purpose of this book is to describe the two methods used in the preparation of the 38 Remedies.

The photograph accompanying the botanical description of each remedy illustrates which part of the plant, tree or bush is used. The botanical descriptions are simple but, it is hoped, sufficient for the seeker to identify the plant. It should be remembered that colour and growth vary greatly with the soil, climate and conditions in which the plant is found, as also does the flowering time. The times are given for an average year.

With each remedy there is a brief indication of its use. The fuller description written by Dr. Edward Bach can be found in his booklet *The Twelve Healers and Other Remedies* which should always be referred to when selecting the Remedies.

It was Dr. Bach's great wish that all possible help should be given to those who would be using this system of medicine and we hope that this book will fulfil that wish.

Nora Weeks and Victor Bullen 1964

Preface

This book, written by Dr. Bach's long-serving and devoted successors, Nora Weeks and Victor Bullen, was originally published in 1964. Its intention was to help those who wished to experience the pleasure of preparing a remedy for themselves. Dr. Bach wanted his work to be easily understood and available to everyone. He wrote *The Twelve Healers & Other Remedies* which describes the indications for each remedy in simple, straightforward language so that people could choose for themselves which remedy or remedies they need. He also believed that as nature is the provider of the flowers and therefore the healing energy itself, knowledge of how to make the remedy preparations should also be available to all.

It was to fulfil Dr. Bach's wish that Nora and Victor decided to write *The Bach Flower Remedies: Illustrations & Preparations*. Little did they know at the time that, less than thirty years later, Dr. Bach's work would be so well known and his remedies used by millions of people throughout the world.

With the exception of Vine and Olive, Dr. Bach found all the plants in England and Wales. Nora and Victor's intention was that only people living in Britain would attempt to make their own remedies, although they knew the information would be of general interest to anyone interested in Dr. Bach's work as a mental image of the plants and the remedies being made, even if only in theory, helps to create a sense of closeness to the natural source.

As it was, the information contained in the book, which had been so freely and explicitly given, was used for the development of other collections of remedies in which Dr. Bach's methods of preparation were adopted, but for a whole range of different plants. For this reason, in 1977, Nora Weeks gave instructions for the book to be withdrawn. The following is an excerpt from a letter she wrote to the publisher:

"We have decided not to send any more of the Illustrated Books to America for many people are preparing them from the wrong flowers and preparing them in the wrong way, and selling them as Bach Remedies ... and this we cannot have."

Nora Weeks, 16th June 1977

Shortly after her death in 1978, *Illustrations & Preparations* was due for reprinting, but in keeping with Nora's wishes, that edition was never published.

Now that Dr. Bach's methods are so well established, having been spoken about and widely documented in various publications over the years, it is our pleasure to re-introduce the book. In so doing, we hope it will achieve its original aims: to give people the opportunity to know how the remedies they may be taking have actually been made, and to enable them to prepare a remedy for themselves if they choose to do so.

The methods are simple, but care must be taken to identify the correct plants as only those which are absolutely true to the plants chosen by Dr. Bach will hold the correct healing properties. Preparing a remedy from the wrong plant – even if it is a very close relative – will not have the desired results. The following passages were written by Nora Weeks shortly before she died:

“We would like to emphasize that the book is essentially for those who wish to prepare their own essences from the actual wild flowers for their own use.

Most of our flowers have many varieties and care is necessary to select the right one. For instance there are many Willows – the Bach Willow, the golden osier, is difficult to distinguish, and the advice of a botanist is necessary. There are also various Centauries, Oaks, Mustard, Heather and Honeysuckles, amongst others. In the autumn of 1977 the Gentian amarella, the autumn Gentian, was nowhere to be found in the usual places, due to the very dry summer of 1976 when the little plants died before their seeds had formed. We searched and searched until one day we thought at first glance we had found it. It was blue in colour with a white fringe at the base of the petals and much taller than usual as it was growing in quite long grass.

However, it was the Gentian campestris, for our Gentian is purplish-blue with a dark fringe at the base of the petals. So you see, even after preparing Gentian for over forty years we could have prepared it in error. There are eight different wild Gentians.

It is, as you see, vitally important to be sure you have the right flower and to prepare it in the right weather conditions. No cultivated or garden flowers must be used, but the wild flowers growing in the soil they choose themselves.”

Nora Weeks

“We ask those living abroad not to prepare the Essences even if the flowers have the same Latin name for, due to the difference in soil and climate, they will not give the desired effect.”

Nora Weeks

Many wild flowers are sadly declining, especially those which rely annually on their seeds to flourish. Some flowers do not propagate or grow densely enough to withstand the loss of even a small quantity of their flower heads, and it could take many years for such a vulnerable area to recover. Potentially it could be disastrous, and it goes without saying that to pick wild flowers under these conditions just for the sake of experimentation would be senseless.

We hope that anyone searching for a suitable location to prepare a remedy will be aware of the struggle for survival that may be going on within a particular habitat, and choose plants growing in abundance such as the White Chestnut blossom, instead of the delicate flowers of the meadow which are much less common. And of course, the enjoyment and pleasure of seeking out the remedy flowers to see them grow and flower, full of life, can be just as rewarding as actually making the remedy itself.

The Mother Tinctures for the Bach Flower Remedies are still made at the Bach Centre, and we are very fortunate to be still able to use many of the locations Dr. Bach originally identified when he lived at Mount Vernon. Thankfully, these locations offer a plentiful crop of flowers. Nevertheless, we are acutely aware of the consequences of taking too many flowers too frequently and take responsible steps to find alternative sources to avoid ever having to “rob” a sparse habitat. That is something we would never do.

Nora Weeks and Victor Bullen felt it was a great privilege to have been asked by Dr. Bach to continue his work. This they did for over forty years with true dedication, upholding the doctor’s principles and never deviating from his earnest wish that the work be kept simple and complete. It is now

our privilege to uphold the same principles and accept the responsibilities bestowed upon us. All of us at the Bach Centre remain true to the same promise that Nora and Victor made to Dr. Bach. That promise lies at the heart of everything the Bach Centre stands for –loyalty to the purity, simplicity and completeness of Dr. Bach’s work, because that is what makes it accessible and available to all, and that is how Dr. Bach wanted it to be.

Judy Howard and John Ramsell

Custodians of the Bach Centre and
Trustees of The Dr. Edward Bach Healing Trust,
Mount Vernon, Sotwell, Oxfordshire.

Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these.

Matthew 6.28

How to prepare the Mother Tinctures and Stock Remedies

The Mother Tinctures

There are three stages in the preparation of the remedies: the first preparation or Mother Tincture; the second preparation or Stock bottle; the third preparation or Treatment bottle.

There are also two methods of preparing the Mother Tinctures: the sun method and the boiling method. The sun method is used for the flowers blooming during the late spring and in the summer when the sun is at the height of its power. The boiling method is used for the flowers and twigs of the trees, bushes and plants, most of which bloom early in the year before there is much sunshine.

Before preparing any Tincture, the plant or tree should be checked with the illustration and the botanical description as there are several varieties of the following: Centaury, Elm, Gentian, Heather, Honeysuckle, Mustard, Oak, Pine, Rock Rose, Scleranthus, Star of Bethlehem and Willow.

There are also cultivated varieties of many of the Remedy flowers: Clematis, Cherry Plum, Gentian, Honeysuckle, Mimulus, Rock Rose, Star of Bethlehem. The *wild* flowers growing in their natural habitat only should be used, with the exception of *Ceratostigma willmottiana* (Plumbago), the Olive and the Vine. The latter two should be prepared in warmer countries, such as the South of France, Italy or Spain.

The times of blooming will vary slightly according to the weather during that part of the year.

For the sun method of preparation, the flowers should be picked about 9 a.m., for the sun is gaining in power during the three hours between then and 12 noon.

The flowers will already have been bathed in sunshine for some hours, and the blooms freshly opened and at their most perfect before the bees and flies and breezes have finished their work of spreading the pollen.

For the boiling method of preparation, a fine sunny morning should also be chosen and the flowers and twigs gathered about 9 a.m. for the same reason.

The flowers should be gathered from as many trees, plants and bushes of the same kind as possible.

Preparing Stock Bottles and Treatment Bottles

The stock bottle is the second stage in the preparation of the remedy and it is from this that the treatment is made up.

To prepare a stock bottle, first fill a sterilized one ounce dropper bottle with brandy. Add two drops from the Tincture bottle of the remedy. Replace cap securely and label with the name of the remedy and “stock”.

The treatment bottle is the third stage in the preparation and it is from this that the required daily doses are taken.

After deciding which remedy or combination of remedies are required, put two drops from each into a sterilized one ounce dropper bottle. Fill this with pure spring or mineral water (available in bottles from most supermarkets or health stores), and a teaspoon of brandy to help preserve the water if it is likely to be subjected to a warm environment. Replace the cap securely and label “treatment”.

From the treatment bottle, the person takes four drops, four times daily – in a tablespoon of water or fruit juice, first thing in the morning, last thing at night, and twice during the day.

To gain the full effect, the dose should be held in the mouth a moment or so before swallowing.

When necessary, the doses can be given more frequently, every quarter or half hourly, and then hourly until the person feels calmer and more peaceful.

For those who find it difficult to make up a treatment bottle in this way, the treatment can be prepared in a glass of water instead, to be sipped at intervals throughout the day.

NB. Full directions for use are available from the Bach Centre.



This photograph of Mimulus, prepared by the Sun Method, was taken by Nora Weeks for the front cover of the original book.

The Sun Method

Requirements

1. One thin, plain glass or crystal bowl, the size of a sugar bowl, to hold about half a pint of water. Not cut glass or oven glass.
2. One small jug, glass or china.
3. A one ounce dropper bottle.

The bowl, jug and bottle should first be sterilized, placed in cold water in a saucepan and gently boiled for twenty minutes, then dried carefully. Wrap the bowl and jug in a clean cloth. When cold, half fill the one ounce bottle

with brandy, put on the cap and label with the name of the Remedy to be prepared and “Tincture”.

4. One empty ½ pint sterilized bottle to be filled with bottled mineral or spring water should there be no clear unpolluted stream near the site where the flowers grow.

Method

Decide beforehand upon the field or hill-top where the plants, trees or bushes are growing, and choose a cloudless sunny morning. Take the bowl, jug, bottle and the one containing the water to this site before 9 a.m.

Place the bowl on the ground near the flowering plants, away from any tall grasses, bushes or trees which might cast a shadow over the bowl as the sun travels across the sky.

Fill the bowl to the brim with water from a nearby clear pure stream, or from the bottle you have brought with you.

Place a broad leaf, preferably from the plant you are preparing, on the palm of the hand and then pick the flower-heads just below the calyx, or the flowering spikes, from as many plants or bushes of the same kind as possible. Quickly float them on the surface of the water in the bowl and repeat this until the whole surface is thickly covered, overlapping the flowers, but seeing that each touches the water.

Avoid casting a shadow over the bowl as you do this, or touching the water with your fingers.

Make a note of the time and leave the bowl in full sunshine for three hours.

At the end of this time and with a stalk from the plant you are preparing, remove the flower-heads, again avoiding touching the water with the fingers.

Pour the now vitalized water into the jug and fill the remaining half of the labelled bottle containing the brandy. Replace cap securely.

The Tincture will retain its strength indefinitely, and is the one from which Stock bottles are prepared ([see here](#)). If the Tincture is kept for several

years, a slight sediment may form at the bottom of the bottle. This is not harmful. The liquid can be filtered into another sterilized bottle and relabelled.

List of Remedies Prepared by the Sun Method These flowers are prepared by the sun method, with the best month in which to prepare them. The date will vary, however, from year to year according to the weather.

[Oak](#) April, May

[Gorse](#) April, May, June

[White Chestnut](#) May, June

[Water Violet](#) May, June

[Mimulus](#) June, July, August

[Agrimony](#) June, July, August

[Rock Rose](#) June, July, August, September

[Centaury](#) June, July, August, September

[Scleranthus](#) June, July, August

[Wild Oat](#) July, August

[Impatiens](#) July, August, September

[Chicory](#) July, August, September

[Vervain](#) July, August, September

[Clematis](#) July, August, September

[Heather](#) July, August, September

[Cerato](#) August, September

[Gentian](#) August, September

[Olive](#) according to the flowering season in the countries where these grow, usually May

[Vine](#) according to the flowering season in the countries where these grow, usually May

[Rock Water](#) June, July



Preparation of Pine by the Boiling Method

The Boiling Method

Requirements

1. A six pint enamel or stainless steel saucepan and lid.
2. Two small china or glass jugs.
3. A one ounce dropper bottle.

These should first be sterilized. Place the jugs and bottle in the saucepan filled with bottled mineral or spring water and boil gently for twenty minutes. Then dry carefully and wrap the jugs in a clean cloth. When cold, half fill the bottle with brandy, put in the cork and label with the name of the Remedy to be prepared and “Tincture”.

4. Two or three pieces of filter paper, obtainable from most chemists and supermarkets.

Method

Decide beforehand upon the wood, hedgerow or field where the trees, bushes or plants are growing. Choose a fine sunny morning, and before 9 a.m. take the saucepan, covered with its lid to keep out the dust, to the chosen spot.

Fill the saucepan three quarters full with the flowering sprays, leaves and twigs (about four ounces). Replace the lid and return home as quickly as possible. Cover the flowers and twigs with two pints of bottled mineral or spring water. Place the saucepan *without* its lid over the heat and bring the water to the boil, pressing the flowers beneath the water with a twig of the same bush or tree from time to time.

Make a note of the time and boil for half an hour.

At the end of half an hour, remove the saucepan from the heat and stand out of doors until cold. When cold, remove all twigs, leaves and flowers with another twig of the same tree or bush to prevent the fingers from touching the water. Allow the saucepan to stand for a further period for the sediment to settle as much as possible.

Cover one of the jugs with filter paper. Fill the other jug carefully from the saucepan without disturbing the sediment, then pour the liquid a little at a time on to the filter paper. This process takes a long time. When sufficient quantity has been filtered, fill the remaining half of the bottle containing the brandy and replace cap securely.

With tree flowers and twigs there is often much sediment and it may be advisable to filter the liquid twice. Even then, after a time – some months – sediment may form at the bottom of the bottle. The liquid should therefore be refiltered and rebottled.

The Tincture will retain its strength indefinitely and is the one from which Stock bottles are prepared ([see here](#)).

List of Flowers Prepared by the Boiling Method These flowers are prepared by the boiling method, with the best month in which to prepare them. The date will vary, however, from year to year according to the weather.

[Cherry Plum](#) February, March, April

[Elm](#) March, April

[Aspen](#) March, April

[Beech](#) April, May

[Chestnut Bud](#) April, May

[Hornbeam](#) April, May

[Larch](#) April, May

[Walnut](#) April, May

[Star of Bethlehem](#) April, May, June

[Holly](#) May

[Crab Apple](#) May

[Willow](#) May

[Red Chestnut](#) May, June

[Pine](#) May, June

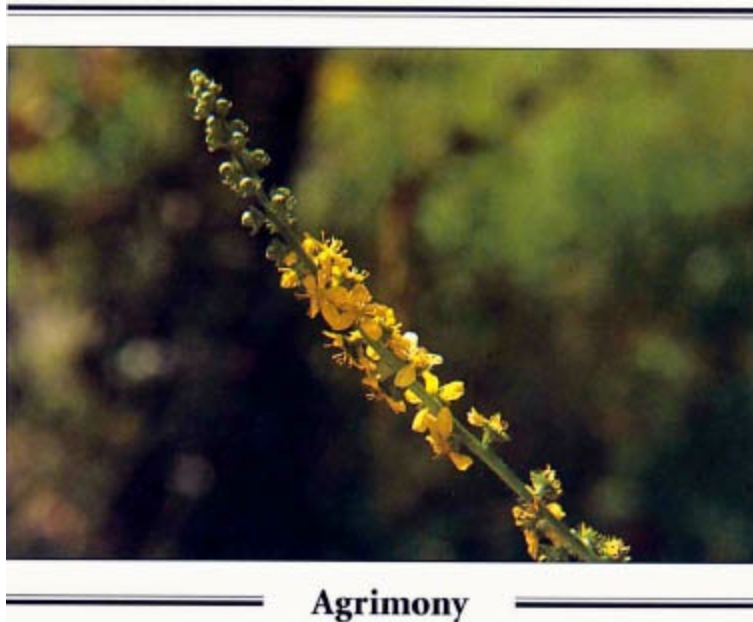
[Mustard](#) May, June, July

[Honeysuckle](#) June, July, August

[Sweet Chestnut](#) June, July, August

[Wild Rose](#) June, July, August

Agrimony



Agrimonia eupatoria

(Russian: Ренешок или Репейничек)

Indication: *for those who hide their worries from others under a cloak of cheerfulness and good humour.*

AGRIMONIA EUPATORIA or **Agrimonia odorata**. Agrimony.

Plant: herbaceous, perennial, two to three feet high, and covered with soft hairs.

Deep green in colour.

Leaves: are divided up the mid-rib into coarsely toothed leaflets, oblong and ovate in shape, with alternate smaller leaflets between, and large leafy stipules at the base. Downy above and more densely so beneath.

Flowers: small and yellow on long tapering leafless spikes. Each flower is attached by a short stalk of its own and each blooms for three days. The lower buds open first. There are five petals and ten to fifteen stamens. The calyx is spiny with five overlapping scales. The flowers face upwards and

outwards, but when they wither, the calyx points downwards and becomes woody and bell-shaped. The spines harden and the bristles hook on to the clothes of passers-by or to the coats of animals and by this means are distributed.

Blooms: from June to August, growing commonly in fields, hedge-banks and all waste places.

Prepare: by the sun method. Pick the flowering spike and end buds above any faded or dead flowers from as many plants as possible, first covering the palm with a broad leaf. Cover the surface of the water in the bowl with the blooms. Choose young plants where there are not too many unopened buds above the fully opened flowers.

Aspen



Aspen

Populus tremula

(Russian: Оси́на)

Indication: *for vague fears of unknown origin.*

POPULUS TREMULA. Aspen.

Tree: rather slender, seldom more than 80 feet in height, with a smooth greyish bark, grey-brown twigs and slightly sticky glossy brown buds.

Leaves: are dark green, two to three inches wide, nearly circular in shape with a blunt pointed tip and bluntly toothed wavy edges. The leaves are woolly when young, but smooth in the autumn. The leaf-stalks are long and slender and flattened which causes the leaves to flutter and tremble in the slightest breeze.

Flowers: male and female catkins appear before the leaves, on different trees. The male catkin is two to three inches long, pendulous with brown hairy scales and reddish anthers. The female catkin is smaller, with a four-lobed purple stigma at the top of a roundish smooth ovary.

Blooms: in March and April, before the leaf-buds burst.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Gather both male and female catkins with about six inches of the twig and young leaf-buds from several trees, sufficient to fill the saucepan three quarters full.

Beech



Beech

Fagus sylvatica

(Russian: Бук европейский)

Indication: intolerance.

FAGUS SYLVATICA. Beech.

Tree: 60 to 100 feet high, with a smooth silver-grey bark.

Leaves: the winter buds are long, slender and pointed with many closely overlapping brown scales which burst early in May at the same time as the flowers.

The leaves are alternate, oval, smooth-faced with straight lateral veins, a pointed apex and slightly toothed margins. At first they are folded and covered with a soft silky down; later they become opaque and glossy.

Flowers: the male and female growing on the same tree and appearing with the leaves. The male flowers have no petals but four to six sepals covered with silky hairs surround eight to sixteen stamens. They cluster to form a hanging purplish-brown tassel on a long stalk. The female flower-clusters

consist of two flowers with many stamens, and are enclosed in a cup of overlapping scales which later become the bristly “mast” protecting the beech-nut.

Blooms: April and May in woods.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Gather the young shoots with the newly opened leaves and the male and female flowers about six inches long from as many trees as possible, filling the saucepan three quarters full.

Centaury



Centaureum umbellatum

(Russian: Золототысячник)

Indication: *for those who lack the will-power to refuse the demands of others and so become willing slaves.*

CENTAURIUM UMBELLATUM. Centaury.

Plant: annual, varying between two and eighteen inches high according to habitat, with a square erect stem, much branched above and terminating in flat divided tufts of small rose-coloured flowers.

Leaves: are oblong, slender and opposite, smooth and pale green with three strong parallel ribs. The leaves have no stalks (sessile), and the root leaves often form a rosette.

Flowers: small and rose-pink, star-like. The corolla is funnel-shaped and five-cleft. The calyx of narrow sepals is also five-cleft. The stamens are five and the anthers become spirally twisted after the flower opens, which it does only in fine weather.

Blooms: from June to August in dry fields, waste places and road-sides.

Prepare: by the sun method. Pick the small tufts of flowers from as many plants as possible, first covering the palm with a broad leaf. Place quickly on the water in the bowl until the surface is completely covered.

Cerato



Ceratostigma willmottiana

(Russian: Свинчатка, свинцовый корень или устели-поле)

Indication: *for those who do not trust their own decisions and repeatedly seek the advice of others.*

CERATOSTIGMA WILLMOTTIANA. Plumbago.

Shrub: deciduous, two to four feet high, a native of Tibet, China, the Himalayas.

The young stems are angled and sometimes reddish.

Leaves: alternate, stalkless, lanceolate, from one to two inches long and bristly on both surfaces.

Flowers: are packed closely in terminal heads, opening successively from the axils of slender lanceolate pointed bracts, edged with stiff bristles. The corolla is slender, a pale blue tube, three quarters of an inch long, with five spreading petals, bright blue in colour, white at the base. The stamens are slender filaments attached to the tube opposite each petal. The anthers are purple in colour. The calyx is five-lobed and awl-shaped.

Blooms: August and September in gardens. This is a cultivated plant in England, there is no wild variety.

Prepare: by the sun method. Choose your flowers from a country garden and pick the single blooms just below the calyx from two or more shrubs if possible, first covering the palm with a broad leaf to protect the delicate flower from the warmth of the hand. Place quickly on the surface of the water in the bowl until it is completely covered.

Cherry Plum



Cherry Plum

Prunus cerasifera

(Russian: Алыча, вишнеслива)

Indication: *fear of the mind giving way.*

PRUNUS CERASIFERA. Cherry plum.

Tree or bush: 10 to 12 feet high, the young twigs usually thornless, commonly used as hedging and shelter-belts round orchards.

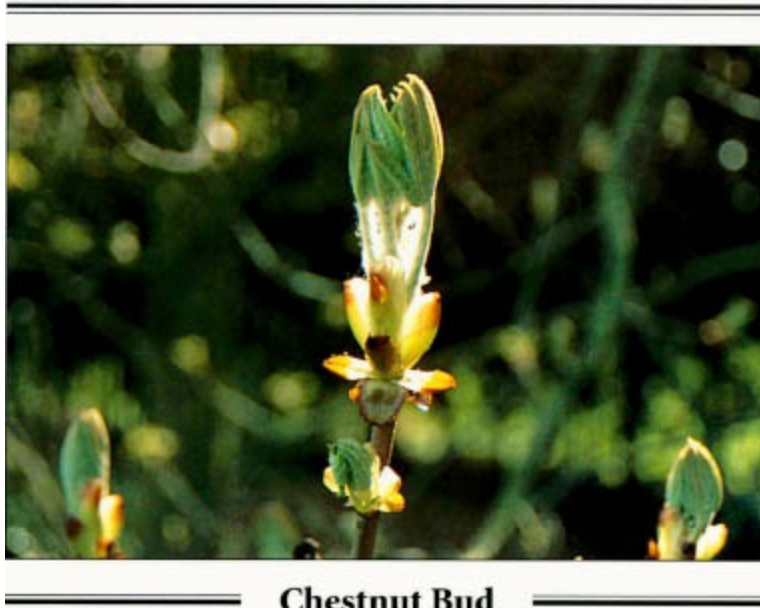
Leaves: are narrow, oval and obovate, half to two inches long and half to one inch wide. The edges are toothed and downy along the mid-rib and the veins beneath.

Flowers: are pure white, three quarters to one inch across, slightly larger than those of the sloe or blackthorn. They are usually produced singly, but sometimes grow two or three together on either side of the leaf-bud, and often form dense clusters on short spur-like twigs. The petals are five in number, the sepals also five, the stamens numerous. The flower stalks are quarter of an inch long. The fruit, which is not produced each year, is small, red and yellow and cherry-like.

Blooms: in early spring, February to April, before the leaves appear.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Pick the flowering twigs with the flowers about six inches long, from as many bushes as possible and place in the saucepan until it is three quarters full.

Chestnut Bud



Aesculus hippocastanum

(Russian: Почки конского каштана)

Indication: *for those who are slow to learn even from repeated experiences.*

AESCULUS HIPPOCASTANUM. The white chestnut. Horse chestnut.

Tree: 80 to 100 feet high, with a grey-brown scaly bark and stout arching branches which turn up at the tips. On the smaller branches are the horse-shoe markings which are the scars of last year's leaf-stalks. The twigs in winter are smooth and light brown with large sticky buds in opposite pairs. The terminal bud is larger than the lateral ones and contains both the leaf and the flower. Each bud is covered with fourteen overlapping scales protected by a resinous substance. The buds gradually swell in early spring, the outer scales fall flat, the shoot within lengthens, the folded leaves at the top are covered with down which is thrown off as the leaves expand.

It is at this stage that the Chestnut Bud is ready for preparing the Remedy. The time April or May: according to the weather. Make certain the trees are

the white chestnut and not the red chestnut.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Pick the bud and about six inches of the twig from as many trees as possible, filling the saucepan three quarters full.

Chicory



Chicory

Chichorium intybus
(Russian: Цикоруй)

Indication: *for those who are possessive and over-critical of others.*

CHICORIUM INTYBUS. Wild Succory.

Plant: a perennial with a tap-root, growing two to three feet high. The tough erect stem is grooved and hairy and has many lateral branches.

Leaves: the root-leaves spread out like a rosette on the ground. They are large and thickly covered with hairs, toothed like the dandelion leaves. The stem-leaves are very much smaller, the upper ones bract-like, the bases clasping the stem.

Flowers: are bisexual and generally grow in clusters of two or three in the axils of the stem-leaves and are stalkless. Usually only a few flowers bloom at the same time. They are composed of two or three rows of bright blue bracts, strap-shaped with a five notched straight end. The outer row of bracts is shorter than the inner one. The stamens and styles are also blue in colour.

Blooms: from July to September and grows on gravel, chalky and waste land, and the open borders of roadsides and fields.

Prepare: by the sun method. These flowers are very sensitive and fade quickly when picked, so cover the palm well with a broad leaf to protect them from the warmth of the hand. Pick two or three flowers only at a time and quickly float them on the surface of the water before gathering more from as many plants as possible.

Clematis



Clematis vitalba

(Russian: Клематис , ломонос)

Indication: *for the day-dreamers who lack sufficient interest in the present.*

CLEMATIS VITALBA. Travellers' Joy. Old Man's Beard.

Shrub: perennial, deciduous, a straggling woody climber over hedges and banks.

The stems when old are thick and rope-like and covered with loose stringy pale brown bark.

Leaves: are opposite and compound, six to eight inches long with three to five oval irregular-toothed leaflets in pairs and a terminal one. The leaf-stalks are long and twisting, by means of which the shrub climbs.

Flowers: are in large panicles on the ends of the short auxiliary branchlets. There are no petals but four to six thick downy sepals about half an inch long, tongue-shaped and petal-like, greenish-white in colour. These

surround a cluster of creamy white stamens and pale green styles. The sepals curve downwards and outwards as the flower matures, and the styles elongate in autumn into long silvery thread-like tails, giving the plant the name of Old Man's Beard.

Blooms: in July, August and September, growing in hedges, thickets and woods on chalky soil and limestone.

Prepare: by the sun method. Gather the separate flowers by their stalks from as many different shrubs and parts of shrubs as possible, and cover the surface of the water in the bowl entirely.

Crab Apple



Malus pumila

(Russian: Дикая яблоня)

Indication: for those who have a feeling of uncleanness.

MALUS PUMILA. Crab Apple.

Tree or large bush: deciduous, low and spreading, 20 to 30 feet high, with a grey and crooked trunk, fissured and cracked. The branches are brown in colour and slightly drooping, with long shoots bearing the leaves and flowers in small clusters on dwarf rigid spurs.

Leaves: are alternate, oval with coarsely toothed margins, darker green and smooth above, paler and downy beneath, and about one and a half inches long.

Flowers: these grow in clusters of five or six with the leaves at the top of a short shoot. The buds are deep rose-pink, the petals, when open, are white tinted with pink, and are heart-shaped and five in number. The calyx is formed of five pointed lobes which are woolly within. Stamens number about 20.

Blooms: in May, according to the season, and grows in hedges, thickets and open woodlands.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Pick the rigid spurs with the leaves and flower clusters from as many trees as possible, filling the saucepan three parts full.

Elm



Elm

Ulmus procera

(Russian: Вяз)

Indication: for those who, although fulfilling their work in life, become despondent at times, feeling the responsibility is too great.

ULMUS PROCERA. The English or common elm.

Tree: 60 to 150 feet high, with a massive trunk, deeply fissured greyish bark, and numerous spreading branches.

Leaves: are two to three and a half inches long, one and a half to two and a half inches broad, growing alternately, broadly oval with sharply toothed margins. The leaves are rough above and downy beneath with a short stalk.

Flowers: these bloom on the bare twigs before the leaves open. They are small and very numerous, in purplish-brown clusters. Each flower has a four-toothed bell-shaped calyx, no petals, four stamens and a one-celled ovary bearing two spreading hairy styles.

Blooms: from February to April according to the weather, in woods and hedgerows.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Pick the twigs with the flower-clusters about six inches in length, from as many trees as possible, sufficient to fill the saucepan three quarters full.

Gentian



Gentian

Gentiana amarella
(Russian: Горечавка)

Indication: for doubt and discouragement.

GENTIANA AMARELLA. Felwort. The autumn Gentian.

Plant: with square, leafy and erect stems, branched or simple, and tinged with crimson or purple, six inches to a foot high.

Leaves: are dark green with three prominent veins, opposite and generally stalkless (sessile). They clasp the stem at the base and are lanceolate in shape.

Flowers: are numerous, single or in clusters and purplish-blue in colour, growing on short stalks in the axils of the leaves. There is one terminal flower at the top of the stem. The corolla-tube is twice as long as the calyx and divides into five lobes with a dense fringe of erect, stiff purple hairs at the mouth of the tube. The calyx is also five-cleft, narrow and acutely pointed and of equal size. The stamens are five and alternate with the five corolla lobes. There is one style and two stigmas.

Blooms: from August to October, on dry hilly pastures, cliffs and dunes.

Prepare: by the sun method. Gather the flowers just below the calyx from as many plants as possible, first covering the palm with a broad leaf. Place quickly on the water in the bowl until the surface is completely covered.

Gorse



Gorse

Ulex europaeus

(Russian: Улекс европейский или Утёсник)

Indication: *for very great hopelessness.*

ULEX EUROPAEUS. Whin, the common furze.

Shrub: an evergreen, two to eight feet high, spreading. The main branches are hairy and from them spring horizontally numerous short branches, grey-green in colour, furrowed and armed with many rigid, sharp and branched spines.

Leaves: are soft and hairy in the seedling, but as the bush matures, they become the sharply pointed linear green spines, half to three quarters of an inch long.

Flowers: are golden-yellow and abundant, formed like those of the pea family, and are produced singly from the leaf-axils of the previous year's shoots on hairy stalks, three quarters of an inch long. The corolla has five petals, the upper or standard petal is bilobed at the apex, the two wing petals are hairy on the lower surface, and the two keel petals are also hairy.

The ten stamens are united to a sheath. The calyx is formed of two sepals, large and covered with blackish hairs outside, with two ovate bracts at the base. The flower is scented during the summer and autumn.

Blooms: most abundantly in April and May, although it begins to flower in February, with odd blooms at all times. It grows abundantly on stony soil, dry exposed commons and heaths.

Prepare: by the sun method in April, May or June. Choose big clumps of bushes and pick the flowers by the hairy stalk from the bushes in the centre and round the circumference of the clump so that the flowers from as many bushes as possible are gathered. Cover the palm of the hand with a broad leaf, and thickly cover the surface of the water in the bowl with the blooms.

Heather



Heather

Calluna vulgaris

(Russian: Вереск обыкновенный)

Indication: *for the talkative self-absorbed people who fear loneliness.*

CALLUNA VULGARIS. Ling. Scotch Heather.

Plant: shrubby and much branched, grows to about two feet high. The stems are rough and wiry and the branches are covered with very short soft hairs.

Leaves: these are small and opposite, and are arranged in four densely packed rows along the branches.

Flowers: mauve-pink in colour, occasionally white, are arranged in leafy spikes (racemes). The corolla is deeply four-lobed and concealed by the longer calyx.

There are eight stamens and a long pistil which protrudes beyond the calyx. The calyx consists of four sepals, mauve-pink like the corolla, dry and

rough. Below it there are four small triangular bracts fringed with soft hairs and a short flower stem.

Blooms: from July to September on heaths, dry moors, and open barren places. It should not be confused with the pinky-red Bell Heather (*Erica cinerea*).

Prepare: by the sun method. Gather the freshly flowering sprays and leaves, above any dead or faded flowers from plants round the circumference and the centre of the heather patch, and place quickly on the surface of the water in the bowl.

Holly



Holly (male)

Ilex aquifolium

(Russian: *Падуб остролистный или Остролист*)

Indication: *for those who suffer from feelings of envy, jealousy, revenge and suspicion.*

ILEX AQUIFOLIUM. Holly.

Tree or bush: a much branched evergreen with a silver-grey smooth trunk and deep green twigs.

Leaves: are short-stalked, alternate, oval and deeply lobed, each lobe ending in a sharp spine. They are two or three inches long, leathery, glossy and dark green above, dull and lighter green on the under surface. The upper leaves of the tree are often without spines.

Flowers: the male and female flowers usually grow on different bushes, but sometimes a bush may be found to be bisexual. The female flowers are small and white with short stalks, growing in the axils of the leaves. The petals are four in number, united into a short tube at the base. The four stamens are arranged alternately with the petals. The male flowers are

similar, but have two to four stigmas forming a disc-like plate on the ovary. The fruit is the red berry.

Blooms: in May and June, in woods and hedgerows.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Pick the flowering twigs, female and/or male flowers, with a few of the leaves, about six inches long from as many bushes as possible. Fill the saucepan three quarters full.

Honeysuckle



Honeysuckle

Lonicera caprifolium

(Russian: Жимолость каприфоль)

Indication: *for those whose thoughts dwell too much upon memories, events and happiness of the past.*

LONICERA CAPRIFOLIUM. Honeysuckle.

Shrub or woody climber with a tough stem.

Leaves: are opposite and entire with no stipules. The lower leaves are stalked, the uppermost pairs are united by their bases round the stem, and are oblong in shape.

Flowers: grow in terminal heads or clusters. The corolla tube is one to two inches long and divides into five lobes which split into two opposite lips. The upper lip of four united lobes, the lower one a single lobe. There are five long and protruding stamens and a pale green pin-headed pistil. The outer surface of the petals is red or deep pink, the inner surface white, but on pollination the flower turns yellow. The calyx is small, the sepals are united, five-toothed and glandular.

Blooms: in June, July and August, in woods, hedgerows and heaths. The *Lonicera caprifolium* is more rare than the yellow-flowered *Lonicera periclymenum*, the common honeysuckle.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Pick the flowering clusters with about six inches of the stalk and leaves, from various parts of the shrub.

Hornbeam



Hornbeam

Carpinus betulus

(Russian: Граб обыкновенный)

Indication: *for those who think they will not have the strength to fulfil their daily tasks.*

CARPINUS BETULUS. Hornbeam.

Tree: 50 to 70 feet high, superficially resembling the beech tree. Its bark is smooth and light grey, its bole deeply fluted. When young, the tree is pyramidal in shape, but later is rounded with the branch-tips pendulous.

Leaves: in spring the new leaves are dark green, oval with doubly serrated edges, downy beneath and on the mid-rib above, one to three and a half inches long. They have a rounded or heart-shaped base and pointed apex. Each has ten to thirteen pairs of veins which run straight and parallel. They are short-stalked and alternate.

Flowers: male and female grow on the same tree, greeny-brown in colour. The male flowers grow in the axils of last year's leaves, and are long

drooping cylindrical catkins with rounded scales, sharp-tipped, one and a half inches long.

Three to twelve stamens are contained in each bract. The female flowers, growing at the end of short lateral shoots, are erect until the fruit forms, then they hang down.

They are produced in pairs facing each other, and have three-lobed greenish scales, large and leaf-like which soon fall off. The middle lobe is one to one and a half inches long and is often toothed. There are two red stigmas.

Blooms: April and May in woods and coppices.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Pick the young twigs with the leaves, male and female flowers, about six inches long from as many trees as possible. Fill the saucepan three parts full.

Impatiens



Impatiens glandulifera

(Russian: Недотрога железистая или бальзамин железистый)

Indication: *impatience and irritability.*

IMPATIENS GLANDULIFERA. Policeman's Helmet.

Plant: annual, succulent and growing up to six feet or more in height. The stems are strong, green or crimson, ribbed and hollow, almost translucent. The side stems branch from swollen joints.

Leaves: are green and smooth with sharply toothed edges and a crimson mid-rib, with a pair of large stalked glands at the base of the leaf-stalk. The leaves are alternate, the ones beneath the flowers are crowded, stalked, broadly lanceolate and pointed, four to six inches long and two and a half inches broad.

Flowers: grow in stalked short whorls which cluster among the uppermost leaves.

The bud bracts are ovate, pale crimson and soon fall off. The sepals are three in number and also pale crimson, two of them being obliquely ovate with a prominent mid-rib which is prolonged into a free tip. The third forms a large wide tube with a spine at the base. The corolla is formed of three petals, the upper one like the standard of the pea-flower, the other two irregular in shape, forming a lip in the front of the flower. All are mauve, some pale mauve and some crimson mauve.

There are five stamens crowding round the ovary.

Blooms: from July to September and grows on river and canal banks and in low-lying damp soil.

Prepare: by the sun method. Use only the *pale mauve* flowers. Pick each flower separately by its stalk from many different plants, covering the palm with a broad leaf first, and cover the surface of the water in the bowl completely.

Larch



Larix decidua

(Russian: Лиственница европейская)

Indication: *for those who lack confidence in themselves and fear failure.*

LARIX DECIDUA. Larch.

Tree: lofty with a straight tapering trunk, 80 to 100 feet high. The bark is brown and as the tree grows, it splits into deep longitudinal fissures. The lower branches are long and spreading with up-turned tips and pendulous greyish-yellow shoots.

Leaves: the drooping twigs bear bunches of 30 to 40 slender needle-like leaves in spreading tufts like brushes. These are bright green in spring, becoming deeper green as the year advances. The Larch is the only coniferous tree to lose its leaves in winter.

Flowers: both sexes grow on the same tree and appear when the leaves are just showing as small bright green tufts. The male flowers are cylindrical catkins about half an inch long, with a mass of golden yellow stamens

cupped in a number of scales. The female catkins are conspicuous, bright red catkins, erect and almost cylindrical.

Blooms: in April and May according to the weather, and grows on hills and the outer edges of woods.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Pick about six inches of the twig with the young green leaf-tufts and the male and female flowers, and gather from as many trees as possible. Fill the saucepan three quarters full.

Mimulus



Mimulus

Mimulus guttatus

(Russian: Губастик или Мимулюс крапчатый)

Indication: for the known fears of everyday life – fear of people, of animals, of the dark, etc.

MIMULUS GUTTATUS. The Monkey flower.

Plant: perennial, about a foot in height with a hollow stem.

Leaves: are rounded, opposite, toothed and smooth. At the base, the broad leaf stem is connected with that of the opposite leaf. There are several veins which run lengthwise.

Flowers: are yellow in colour, large and solitary, growing from the axils of the upper leaves on a flower stalk up to an inch and a half long. The corolla tube opens out into five large spreading lobes, the two upper ones slightly smaller than the three lower ones. The lower lip is more or less marked with small purple or reddish spots at the mouth of the tube. There are four stamens surrounding the pistil.

The calyx is leafy, bell-shaped and five lobed.

Blooms: from June to August, in and near streams and brooks and in wet places. It is a naturalized plant in England and belongs to the same family as the Musk (*Mimulus moschatus*).

Prepare: by the sun method. Gather the flowers by their stalks from as many plants as possible, first covering the palm with a broad leaf to protect the delicate flowers from the warmth of the hand. Cover the surface of the water in the bowl with the blooms. Cultivated garden plants should never be used.

Mustard



Sinapis arvensis

(Russian: Горчица полевая)

Indication: for the deep depression and gloom for which no explanation can be given.

SINAPIS ARVENSIS. Charlock. Wild Mustard.

Plant: an annual, one to two feet high, with upright branched stems which are grooved and often covered with short, rough hairs.

Leaves: the lower ones have short stalks, the upper ones are stalkless, rough and lyre-shaped with coarsely toothed edges and a few stiff hairs mostly on the lateral forked nerves. On the leaf-stalk below the larger leaves there are a few smaller leaves.

Flowers: are arranged at first in close racemes or clusters which soon elongate as the fruits are formed. The flower-stalks are very short. The corolla is formed of four petals, spoon-shaped with slender claws, which are bright yellow in colour.

There are six stamens, four long and two short, with rather large anthers, arrow-shaped at the base. The spreading sepals of the calyx are four in number and soon fall off.

Blooms: in May, June and July in fields and waysides.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Pick the flower-heads above the faded blooms and seed-pods from as many plants as possible, filling the saucepan three quarters full.

Oak



Quercus robur

(Russian: Дуб обыкновенный)

Indication: *for the depression suffered by those brave people who fight strongly against adverse conditions without losing hope.*

QUERCUS ROBUR. The common oak.

Tree: deciduous, 60 to 80 feet high, with a massive trunk and grey-brown, thick, rough and deeply furrowed bark. The branches are many, tortuous and spreading.

The twigs are greyish, bent and end in dense clusters of small, blunt, light brown and scaly buds.

Leaves: two to four inches long, short-stalked and oval in shape, dark green above and greyish-green beneath. They are alternate and deeply lobed, each lobe being rounded at the tip and with two folded ear-like lobes at the leaf-base.

Flowers: both male and female are borne on the same tree. The male catkins form loose drooping clusters, one to one and a half inches long, and are yellowish in colour, usually borne on the previous year's shoots. The female flowers are fewer and more inconspicuous, hidden amongst the leaves. They grow from the upper leaf axils of the new shoots, and occur in groups of two to five on a short erect stalk.

They are formed of a cup-shaped calyx of a number of overlapping scales enclosing an ovary with three crimson styles. The calyx scales later form the cup for the acorn.

Blooms: with the young leaves in late April and May, according to the season. The Oak grows commonly in woods, hedgerows and meadows.

Prepare: by the sun method. Choose a field near a grove of Oaks and gather the *female* catkins only from as many different trees as possible, first covering the palm with a broad leaf to protect the flowers from the warmth of the hand. Cover the surface of the water in the bowl with the flowers.

Olive



Olea europaea

(Russian: Маслина европейская или оливковое дерево)

Indication: *for complete mental exhaustion.*

OLEA EUROPAEA. Olive.

Tree: a small evergreen, 30 to 40 feet high, with many thin branches. The bark is pale grey in colour.

Leaves: are opposite and lanceolate, leathery and about two and a half inches long.

They are entire, acute and smooth, silvery beneath and pale green above.

Flowers: are borne in clusters or racemes, small and inconspicuous, 20 to 30

flowers to each inflorescence, arising from the axils of the leaves. The corolla tube is short and divides into four petals, whitish in colour and spreading. The two stamens are attached to the corolla tube. The ovary is

divided into two cells, the style is short and the stigma bilobed. The calyx is cup-shaped and very shortly four-toothed.

Blooms: in spring, according to the climate of the country where the tree grows.

Prepare: by the sun method. Cover the palm with a broad leaf to protect the delicate flowers from the heat of the hand, and pick the flower clusters from as many trees as possible. Place them quickly on the water, covering the whole surface.



Pine



Pinus sylvestris

(Russian: Сосна обыкновенная)

Indication: *for self-reproach.*

PINUS SYLVESTRIS. Scots Pine.

Tree: an evergreen, growing up to a height of 100 feet, with a straight cylindrical trunk, a rough bark, the lower part being reddish-brown, the upper part and the branches orange-brown in colour. The branches are short and spreading.

Leaves: grow in pairs in dense tufts. They are from two to three inches long, slender and needle-like, grooved above and convex beneath. They appear at the ends of the pale brown, scaly twigs and are surrounded at the

base by a band of small scales. In the centre of each tuft is a cluster of golden brown, resinous, pointed buds. The leaves fall off every two or three years and are of a whitish-blue colour the first year, but become deep dark green later on.

Flowers: the male and female grow on the same tree. The golden-yellow male flowers are small and form clusters, abundantly covered with yellow pollen, at the top of the shorter shoots. The female flowers or cones grow singly or in small clusters of three, red and egg-shaped, at the apex of the year-old shoots.

Blooms: in May and early June, in pine woods and on heathland.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Pick about six inches of the young shoots together with the male and female flowers, and when the male flowers are in full pollen, from as many trees as possible. Fill the saucepan three quarters full.

Red Chestnut



Red Chestnut

Aesculus carnea

(Russian: Каштан конский красный)

Indication: *for fear and over-anxiety for others.*

AESCULUS CARNEA. Red Chestnut.

Tree: smaller and less robust than the White or Horse Chestnut. The trunk is deeply furrowed with a greenish smooth bark which later becomes scaly. The buds are borne in opposite pairs in the axils of last year's leaves. The terminal ones are larger than the lateral buds, and are covered by large overlapping bud-scales, protected by a glutinous substance.

Leaves: as the leaves emerge they are covered with white down, the leaflet drooping until the leaf is fully expanded in early May. They are large,

compound and formed by five or seven leaflets, broadening towards the tip then suddenly tapering to a point. The margins are serrated.

Flowers: these are in large upright inflorescences, pyramidal in shape as the lowest flowers have longer stalks. The corolla is formed of four or five petals of unequal size, the colour is pinky-red. There are five to eight stamens which have long curved filaments, and the style is also long and curved. The calyx is formed of five joined sepals.

Blooms: in late May and early June according to the season.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Gather about six inches of the twig with the flowering pyramid and young leaves, from as many trees as possible and fill the saucepan three quarters full.

Rock Rose



Rock Rose

Helianthemum nummularium

(Russian: Солнцецвет монетолистный или гелиантемум)

Indication: *for extreme fear, terror, panic.*

HELIANTHEMUM NUMMULARIUM. Rock Rose.

Plant: perennial. A low, spreading, shrubby plant with short much branched woody stems which trail on the ground. Branchlets are produced annually up to a foot long.

Leaves: these are narrow, oblong and opposite, shortly stalked and entire. They are green above and white beneath and covered with branched hairs. The stipules are long and slender.

Flowers: bright yellow in colour, growing in terminal racemes, the lower flowers blooming first, and usually only one or two at a time. The blooms are quickly over when the flower-stalks bend downwards. The petals are five in number, soft and crumpled. The sepals are also five: three large and two small ones. The stamens surrounding the pistil are numerous.

Blooms: from June to September and grows on chalky downs, limestone and gravelly soils. It is said to be unknown in Ireland. The many-coloured cultivated rockery plants are not used.

Prepare: by the sun method. First cover the palm with a broad leaf to protect the delicate flowers by the flower-stalks, a few at a time from as many plants as possible. Place quickly on the surface of the water.

Rock Water



Aqua petra

(Russian: Скальная, родниковая вода)

Indication: for those who practise too rigid a self-discipline and are hard masters to themselves.

ROCK WATER.

This is the water taken from some well or spring known for its power to heal the sick.

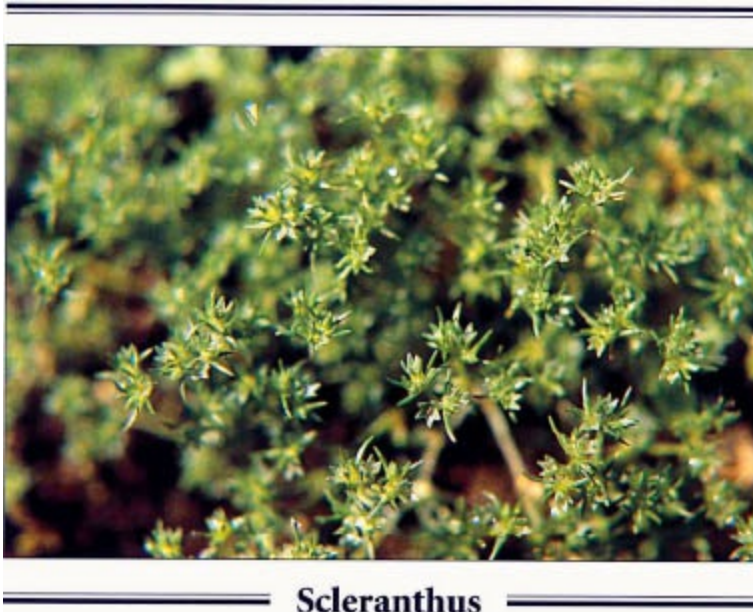
Not the water of spas, well-known for their valuable medicinal properties, nor the wells and springs over which chapels and shrines have been built by man, but the half-forgotten spring or well, many of which are still to be found in various parts of the country, in its natural state, open to the sunshine and the air, amongst the trees or in the fields, or some village churchyard.

Prepare: by the sun method. Fill the glass bowl to the brim from the well or spring, place it on the ground in the sunshine for three hours on any

perfect sunny day during the summer. The sun is at its greatest strength during the months of June and July.

The natural well at Wellsprings, Brightwell-cum-Sotwell, a short walk from Mount Vernon. Dr. Bach found it contained healing properties beneficial to the eyes and used it to prepare the Rock Water remedy while he lived in the village.

Scleranthus



Scleranthus annuus

(Russian: Дивала однолетняя или Ежа одногодичная)

Indication: *for those who cannot make up their minds between two things. They do not seek the advice of others.*

SCLERANTHUS ANNUUS. The annual Knawel.

Plant: small, bushy or procumbant, two to four inches high with numerous tangled stems.

Leaves: are awl-shaped, opposite and small, green, darker or lighter according to the soil in which the plant grows.

Flowers: are also pale or darker green in colour and grow either in the forks of the stems or in terminal tufts. There are no petals but a five cleft calyx, the pointed sepals being whitish at the edges, and contracted at the mouth of the tube. There are ten stamens and two styles.

Blooms: from July to September in wheat fields and sandy and gravelly soils.

Prepare: by the sun method. Pick the flowering stems and leaves from as many plants as possible, protecting the blooms from the warmth of the hand by a broad leaf. Cover the surface of the water in the bowl thickly with the flowering stems.

Star of Bethlehem



Star of Bethlehem

Ornithogalum umbellatum

(Russian: *Птицемлечник зонтичный*)

Indication: *for shock.*

ORNITHOGALUM UMBELLATUM. Star of Bethlehem.

Plant: closely allied to the onion and garlic, growing from a small bulb.

Leaves: these arise from the bulb and are long, very slender (like the leaves of the crocus), dark green with a white line down the centre.

Flowers: a leafless stalk grows from the centre of the bulb, six inches to a foot high, ending in the cluster or umbel of flowers. The central stalks of the umbel are longer than the outer ones. The flowers have no calyx but a

star-like corolla of six petals, which are very white inside, with a green stripe down the outer surface.

There are six stamens. The flowers open only in the sunshine.

Blooms: from April to May and grows in meadows and small woods.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Pick the flowering clusters when they are fully open, with a small piece of the main stem from as many plants as possible, filling the saucepan three quarters full.

Sweet Chestnut



Sweet Chestnut

Castanea sativa

(Russian: Каштан съедобный, посевной, европейский или благородный)

Indication: *extreme anguish in those who have reached the limit of their endurance.*

CASTANEA SATIVA. The Spanish Chestnut. The edible chestnut.

Tree: deciduous, 60 to 80 feet high, with a grey-brown thick bark which is deeply furrowed longitudinally, and which, as the tree matures, begins to twist spirally around the trunk.

Leaves: are large, glossy, alternate, dark green above, rather downy beneath and about five to nine inches long, two and a half inches broad, with a short stalk. They are elliptical in shape, tapering to a point at each end. The margins are toothed with sharp spreading teeth.

Flowers: appear after the leaves, the male and female flowers growing on the same tree. The catkins are long, five to six inches, slender and pale yellow, arising from the axils of the leaves. The catkins arising from the lower leaf axils are entirely male and have eight to ten stamens surrounded

by a calyx of five to six green sepals. The ripe pollen has a sickly scent. The female flowers are fewer in number and grow in clusters of two or three in a four-lobed involucre (a number of bracts enclosing several flowers) at the base of the catkins in the axils of the upper leaves.

The calyx closely surrounds a tapering ovary, at the top of which are five to six radiating stigmas. The involucre later joins together to form the thick leathery hull which covers the ripening seeds – the edible chestnut.

Blooms: later than most trees from June to August, in open woods.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Gather about six inches of the twig with leaves, male and female flowers from as many trees as possible.

Vervain



Verbena officinalis

(Russian: Вербена лекарственная)

Indication: for the strain and tension felt by those over-enthusiastic people who have fixed and rigid ideas.

VERBENA OFFICINALIS. Vervain.

Plant: a perennial growing a foot or two high, with a tough erect and branching stem. The stem is four-angled and sparsely covered with short hairs.

Leaves: are opposite and lanceolate, deeply cut and coarsely toothed, with short hairs on both surfaces.

Flowers: are small, pale mauve or lilac, growing on slender terminal and auxillary spikes. The lower buds open first. The corolla tube divides into five unequal lobes, and white hairs at the mouth of the tube hide the four stamens. The calyx is also five lobed.

Blooms: from July to September and grows by the roadside, in dry waste places and sunny pastures.

Prepare: by the sun method. Gather the flowering spikes above any fading or dead flowers from as many plants as possible. Choose the younger plants so that there are not too many unopened buds above the fully opened flowers. Cover the surface of the water in the bowl completely.

Vine



Vine

Vitis vinifera

(Russian: Виноград культурный)

Indication: for those efficient strong-minded people who are inclined to be dominant and force their will upon others.

VITIS VINIFERA. Grape vine.

Shrub: a deciduous and long-lived tendril climbing shrub, 50 feet or more in length with woody stems.

Leaves: these are three to five inches wide, three to five lobed and coarsely toothed, growing alternately, with small stipules at the base. The tendrils, which help in supporting the shoots, arise opposite two-thirds of the leaves.

Flowers: grow in dense clusters and are small, green and fragrant. There are five petals which unite at the tips forming a cap which is pushed off when the stamens are ripe. The calyx is small, forming a rim at the base of the petals and is five-lobed or toothed. The five stamens are opposite the petals. The berry is the grape.

Blooms and grows in warmer countries and the time of flowering varies with the climate.

Prepare: by the sun method. Pick the flowering clusters when at their most perfect from as many different shoots of the vine as possible. Cover the surface of the water in the bowl with the blooms.

Walnut



Walnut

Juglans regia

(Russian: Орех серый)

Indication: for the definite people who at times are led away from their own aims and work by the strong opinions of others.

JUGLANS REGIA. Walnut.

Tree: 40 to 100 feet high, with a big bole and huge spreading head. The bark is grey, smooth when young, but with deep longitudinal furrows forming as the tree matures, making it very rugged. The twisted branches take an upward turn.

Leaves: these appear late and are large with a variable number of smooth lance-shaped leaflets with slightly wavy edges in opposite pairs. The young shoots and leaves are reddish in colour.

Flowers: both male and female grow on the same tree. The male flower is a drooping catkin with a calyx of four to five scales, greenish in colour, enclosing a large number of stamens. The female flowers are solitary or a few may be grouped at the end of the shoot. They are few in number. The

calyx, bottle-shaped, closely surrounds the ovary which has two or three fleshy stigmas. The flowers bloom before or just as the leaf-buds burst. The fruit is the edible walnut.

Blooms: in early spring, April and May, in hedgerows and orchards.

Prepare: by the boiling method, picking about six inches of the young shoot, leaves and *female* flowers from as many trees as possible. Fill the saucepan three quarters full.

Water Violet



Hottonia palustris

(Russian: Турча болотная, хоттония)

Indication: for the quiet, self-reliant people who tend at times to be too proud and aloof.

HOTTONIA PALUSTRIS. Water Violet.

Plant: growing in water, and belonging to the Primrose family, not to the violets or pansies.

Leaves: are many in number, forming a rosette at the base of the vertical flower stem. They are finely divided like a feather. This rosette serves to maintain the erect position of the flowering stem above the water, the leaves being submerged.

Flowers: are pale lilac with a yellow eye, and arranged in whorls one above the other round a leafless stalk. The flower-stalks have linear bracts, and curve downwards when the seeds are forming. The calyx has five narrow lobes, the petals are five-lobed, joined at the base. The five stamens are arranged opposite the lobes of the corolla and are attached to the tube.

Blooms: in early summer, May and June, growing in slow-moving streams, pools and ditches.

Prepare: by the sun method. Gather the flowers by their stalks from as many different plants as possible, and cover the surface of the water in the bowl with them. It is useful to have a walking-stick with a crook handle to draw the plants gently to the bank as they often grow well out in the stream.

White Chestnut



Aesculus hippocastanum

(Russian: Конский каштан обыкновенный)

Indication: *for persistent worrying thoughts and mental arguments.*

AESCULUS HIPPOCASTANUM. The Horse Chestnut.

Tree: 80 to 100 feet in height, with a grey-brown scaly bark and stout arching branches which turn up at the tips in winter. On the smaller branches are the horseshoe markings which are the scars of last year's leaf-stalks. The twigs in winter are smooth and light brown with large sticky buds in opposite pairs. The terminal bud is larger than the lateral ones and contains both the leaf and the flower.

Each bud is covered with fourteen overlapping scales protected by a resinous substance. The buds swell in early spring, the outer scales fall flat, the shoot within lengthens, the folded leaves at the top are covered with down which is thrown off as the leaves expand.

Leaves: as the leaflets emerge they droop and then expand, and when fully developed are large and fan-shaped. They are divided at the base into five or seven leaflets of different sizes with finely toothed margins.

Flowers: may be single or double and grow in dense erect spikes, the lower flowers having longer stalks thus forming a pyramid. The bell-shaped light green calyx has five lobes, the corolla five, six or seven petals, crinkled and pure white, splashed and dotted with crimson and yellow towards the base of the upper petal.

The five to eight stamens are strongly curved, with a longer curved style. The upper flowers are usually male, the lower ones female.

Blooms: in late May and early June.

Prepare: by the sun method. Pick the male and female flowers (double or single) by their stalks from as many trees as possible, and cover the surface of the water in the bowl thickly with the blooms.

Wild Oat



Bromus ramosus

(Russian: Овсяг, Лесной костер или Дикий овес)

Note: The name Wild Oat has been the subject of much confusion because *Bromus ramosus*, the plant chosen by Dr. Bach, is the grass commonly known as Hairy brome or Wood brome, whereas Wild oat is the common name for *Avena fatua* which looks quite different. However, “*bromus*” comes from the Greek word *bromos*, meaning oats, which is why Dr. Bach called the remedy “Wild Oat”.

Indication: dissatisfaction and uncertainty in those who are talented but cannot determine their course in life.

BROMUS RAMOSUS. Hairy or Wood Brome-grass.

Grass with an erect, hairy, unbranched culm (stem) from two to six feet long.

Leaves: are green, broad and flat, long, drooping and finely pointed, the lower leaves are hairy. The tubular sheaths of the leaves clasp the main stem and are covered with long reflexed hairs.

The flower head (or panicle): at the top of the main stem is formed of many fine pendulous branches, usually in pairs, and from each of these branches arise two to four stemmed spikelets which are composed of overlapping scales. The two outer scales, called glumes, are bracts at the base of the spikelet, unequal in size and rounded at the back (keeled). The shorter glume is sharply pointed and has one nerve, the longer glume or bract is three to five nerved and bluntly pointed. The inner two scales, the lemma and the palea, enclose the bisexual flower. The lemma is oblong-lanceolate in shape, firm with a narrow membranous margin, with short hairs at the back. It is seven nerved and has a fine straight needle-like appendage (the awn) arising just below the apex. The lemma closely embraces the shorter scale, the keeled palea, and hidden at the base of these two scales is the flower, with two small scales enclosing the stamens, ovary and two feathery pistils.

Blooms: in July and August, and grows in damp woods, hedgerows, thickets and by roadsides. Widespread in the British Isles.

Prepare: by the sun method. Pick the flowering spikelets when in full pollen from many grasses, and cover the surface of the water in the bowl thickly.

The *Bromus ramosus* does not look like the cultivated oat in appearance, and it may be difficult to identify.

Wild Rose



Rosa canina

(Russian: Шиповник собачий)

Indication: *for resignation and apathy.*

ROSA CANINA. Dog Rose.

Shrub or bush: four to five feet high, with long arching and prickly branches. The thorns or prickles are equal and hooked.

Leaves: are alternate and broken up into five to seven sharply toothed leaflets, usually in two or three pairs with one terminal leaf, oval in shape. The leaf stalk is joined to the stem by a large two-lobed stipule.

Flowers: white, pink or deep rosy-pink, are either solitary or grow three or four together at the ends of the branches with long stalks. The petals are five in number, notched, large and heart-shaped. The stamens are numerous, and the styles free and hairy. The sepals are five, pinnate, and when the flower opens, they turn downwards towards the stem. The fruit is the “hip” which, when ripe, is deep red.

Blooms: from June to August, and grows in thickets, hedges and the fringes of woodlands.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Gather the flowers with a short piece of the stem and leaves from as many bushes as possible. Fill the saucepan three quarters full.

Willow



Willow

Salix vitellina

(Russian: Ива желтая)

Indication: *for resentment and bitterness.*

SALIX VITELLINA. The Yellow Willow. The Golden Osier.

Tree: often pollarded, whose bole is covered with a strong thick grey-brown bark, rough and deeply fissured. The twigs are flexible, smooth and resilient, and turn a bright orange-yellow in winter.

Leaves: grow alternately, are short stalked, narrow and lance-like, tapering to a slender tail-like point, two to four inches long. They are glossy green above and silky beneath, with edges faintly toothed.

Flowers: the catkins, male and female, grow on different trees, and are long and slender. They appear with the unfolding leaves and are pollinated chiefly by the wind.

Blooms: early in May and grows on moist and low-lying ground.

Prepare: by the boiling method. Pick the catkins, either sex, with about six inches of the twig and young leaves from as many trees as possible.

There are many varieties of the Willow tree, but the *Salix vitellina* (vitellina – like the yoke of an egg) can always be recognized by its brilliant yellow twigs in winter.

Further Information

Advice, details of remedies, educational activities, general information and the following books concerning Dr. Bach's work may be obtained from:

The Dr. Edward Bach Centre, Mount Vernon, Sotwell, Wallingford, Oxon, OX10 0PZ England

Books about the Bach Flower Remedies:

Dr. Edward Bach, *The Twelve Healers and Other Remedies* (The C.W. Daniel Company, Saffron Walden, Essex)

Dr. Edward Bach, *Heal Thyself* (The C.W. Daniel Company, Saffron Walden, Essex)

Stefan Ball, *Bach Flower Remedies for Men* (The C.W. Daniel Company, Saffron Walden, Essex)

Stefan Ball, *The Bach Remedies Workbook* (The C.W. Daniel Company, Saffron Walden, Essex)

Philip Chancellor, *Illustrated Handbook of the Bach Flower Remedies* (The C.W.

Daniel Company, Saffron Walden, Essex)

Jane Evans, *Introduction to the Benefits of the Bach Flower Remedies* (The C.W.

Daniel Company, Saffron Walden, Essex)

Judy Howard and John Ramsell (editors), *The Original Writings of Edward Bach* (The C.W. Daniel Company, Saffron Walden, Essex) Judy Howard, *The Bach Flower Remedies Step by Step* (The C.W. Daniel Company, Saffron Walden, Essex)

Judy Howard, *Bach Flower Remedies for Women* (The C.W. Daniel Company, Saffron Walden, Essex)

Judy Howard, *Growing up with Bach Flower Remedies* (The C.W. Daniel Company, Saffron Walden, Essex)

Judy Howard, *The Story of Mount Vernon* (The Bach Centre, Oxfordshire)

T.W. Hyne-Jones, *Dictionary of the Bach Flower Remedies* (The C.W. Daniel Company, Saffron Walden, Essex)

John Ramsell, *Questions and Answers* (The C.W. Daniel Company, Saffron Walden, Essex)

Nora Weeks, *The Medical Discoveries of Edward Bach, Physician* (The C.W.

Daniel Company, Saffron Walden, Essex)

F.J. Wheeler, *The Bach Remedies Repertory* (C.W. Daniel Company, Saffron Walden, Essex)

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